



The Standard

November 1996

"WE HAVE NO CHOICE!"

Since the beginning of time, the battle for truth and righteousness has raged! There may have been periods when the battle has been waged more fiercely than at other times, but the conflict between right and wrong has consistently continued.

Those who find themselves in leadership positions are in the heat of the battle today. We are facing some very complex issues. However, it has always fallen the lot of ones in leadership to chart a course, take a stand, and point the way. It is not always easy or popular to do so. Yet the responsibility of a leader involves "minding the flock" which the Lord has placed you over. As leaders, we cannot be neutral! A leader has a responsibility to others, to his God, and to himself. That's the very reason the little cliché was coined, "there's a lot of room at the top," because leading is not always fun and games. You often run the risk of being misunderstood, unpopular, unappreciated, and ridiculed when you find yourself having to make determinations concerning issues, individuals, and institutions. However, that is a part of leadership. It goes with the territory. In this day of uncertainty in so many arenas, we cannot afford to be hesitant in our decisions. It appears, however, that many leaders today do not want to make any decision that will differ from public or popular opinion.

I don't understand the hesitancy when we still have the same reliable, trustworthy source to help us in making decisions. IT IS THE BIBLE--The Holy Scriptures--God's Word! It is still the Inspired, Infallible, Inerrant, Eternal, Complete, Immutable Word of God! In an age of constant flux and uncertainty, we have the anchor of God's "sure" Word to rely upon.

One of the pressing issues facing us today is the very popular Promise Keepers (PK) movement. I did not ask to be brought into this matter. As a leader, however, it is my responsibility to know something about issues and movements so I will be

able to give proper comment and advice concerning them. Thus, I had to find something out about PK. My problem and question concerning PK is not with the seven promises of the PK. At first glance, it is not hard to understand why a lot of people would feel that such a movement is needed. However, we cannot make our decisions based on just what we see and hear. We must scratch below the surface! I cannot forget everything I have been taught and know concerning ecclesiastical separation and doctrine. I can understand how some laymen may get involved. I don't understand why pastors refuse to hold the PK movement to



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the same criteria for judgment as we have other movements and issues through the years.

My problem with the PK movement is with their ecumenism. It seems they have no regard for the Scriptures when it comes to this matter. The argument, "If you haven't been, don't criticize it," is dangerous logic. Such logic elevates "experience" over "theology." Experience can never become the basis of our theology. It must always be the Word of God!

I want people to like me, and I want to be accepted by my peers. I don't want to be labeled as "being agin" everything. But I cannot turn my head and simply "go with the flow" just to be accepted by a certain peer group. As a leader, I am to be God's man. That means I have an obligation, yea, a responsibility to my God, to the people I lead, and to myself to find out what the Bible says, not just about PK, but every issue or movement that comes down the "pike!"

There are enough problem areas of concern with the PK, such as: ecumenism, charismatic connections, Catholic connections, and doctrinal positions to warrant a thorough investigation of this movement. It is "only" after we have done this, that I feel we are capable of making an intelligent, Biblical recommendation.

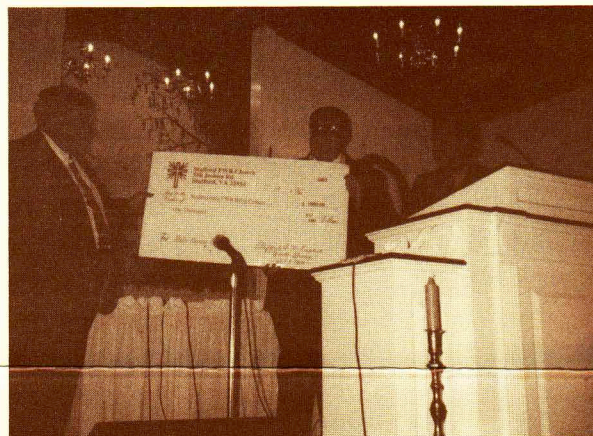
May God help us not to grow "weary in well doing," and may we continue to wage the battle for "truth" till Jesus comes. We have no other choice! ("...it is needful for me to write unto you and exhort you that ye should earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered unto the saints." Jude 6)

President Billy Bevan

Stafford Church Presents Check for Activities Center

The young people at Stafford FWB Church in Stafford, VA, wanted to raise funds for the new activities center to be built at Southeastern. To make their efforts even more worthwhile, they challenged the adults to match the amount they could raise. The adults accepted the challenge and on Sunday, September 15, Pastor Greg Bevan presented a check in the amount of \$3,282

to President Bevan. Our heartfelt thanks to the pastor, the youth, and everyone at Stafford FWB Church who worked to complete this project so successfully.



INTERNET CORRECTIONS!

**WE HAD NOT ONE BUT TWO
MISPRINTS IN OUR LAST STANDARD.
HERE ARE THE CORRECTIONS:**

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www.ntrnet.net/~baerd

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CHECK US OUT!

*Still
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the newest recording
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The Sounds of Victory.

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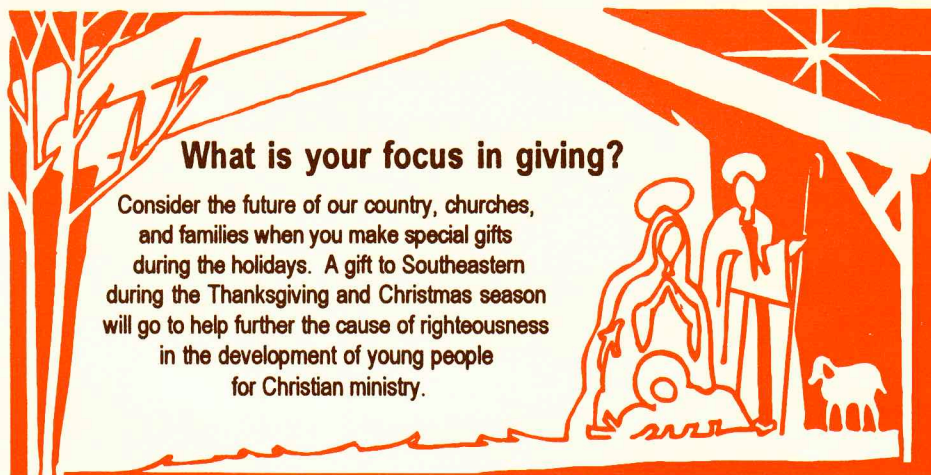
Tapes \$10, CD's \$15

Order 10 and get one free!

(Order and pay now to save shipping
charges. We should be shipping in January!)

What is your focus in giving?

Consider the future of our country, churches, and families when you make special gifts during the holidays. A gift to Southeastern during the Thanksgiving and Christmas season will go to help further the cause of righteousness in the development of young people for Christian ministry.



MISCHA BEVAN SCHOLARSHIPS AWARDED

The Mischa Bevan Memorial Scholarship fund was established in memory of Mischa Bevan, the oldest daughter of President and Mrs. Bevan. Its purpose is to help young men and women who are going into full-time Christian service by providing educational financial assistance. The good response from churches, ladies' groups, and individuals allowed us to present fifteen \$500 scholarships and three \$250 scholarships to students this year. The staff and students would like to express our sincere appreciation to everyone who contributed toward the scholarship fund this year. Some received special offerings, while others sponsored projects with the profits given to the scholarship fund. This fund is a great blessing to so many of our students who are working every day to pay their school bill.

Students who received \$500 scholarships were: Kim Beavers, Beth Cash, Mike Cash, Jerry Hall, Beth Harrelson, David Hunt, Jimmy Lawson, Jonathan Lewis, Shanna Lilly, Kyle Logan, April Stewart, Brian Thomas, David Usry, Craig Villines, and Christopher Wall. Students receiving \$250 scholarships were: Carroll Bazen, Todd Bronson, and Christy Madison.

We accept contributions all year for this scholarship fund but our emphasis time is late spring and through the summer in order to award scholarships near the time of Mischa's birthday which was September 30. If your group has never contributed to this project, we ask that you prayerfully consider doing so next year. As our enrollment continues to grow so do the number of students who need our assistance.



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Highlights from the Missions Conference and Missions Retreat

Missions Retreat: "Great!" "The Best!" "Do we have to go back to college?" "Can't we stay longer?" These were some of the comments which we heard from the 46 students who attended our fall missions retreat. Our speakers, Rev. Ernest Holland and his wife, Elaine, did an excellent job in speaking to our students by sharing their testimonies, work and burden for missions. Our theme "Hear Their Cry" made a lasting impression on all of our hearts and mainly focused our eyes on the field of the world.

Missions Conference: My, how the Lord spoke to our hearts during our recent Missions Conference. God certainly used our speakers (Dr. M. A. Thomas, Rev. Don Bailey, Rev. Johnny Pike, Rev. Dann Patrick) and the testimonies and drama by our students. Our theme, "No Man Careth for My Soul" was burned into our hearts. Many have said, "This has been our greatest conference." Dr. Lassiter remarked in chapel recently that we had some of the best preaching that he had ever heard. Hearts were blessed, challenged, and broken for the millions who are dying without Christ. Our students made many decisions for missions and now we are praying that they will stay faithful to their commitment. Pastors, please mark your calendars for next year's conference, October 16-17.



SPOTLIGHT ON ALUMNI

Michael Lee received the BS degree in Teacher Education from Southeastern in 1989. Upon graduation, he was employed by Hilltop Christian School, Fuquay Varina, NC, working with both high school and elementary students and also served as a deacon at Hilltop FWB Church. While there, Michael married Ginger Young but lost her soon after their wedding in a tragic auto accident. In 1994, Michael moved to Georgetown, SC, where he is currently employed by Calvary Christian School as math instructor and works at Wildes Furniture Company. He also serves as deacon at Calvary FWB Church.

